

Personal Budget and Decision Plan

NAME _____ DATE _____ PERIOD _____

Part 1: Read the fixed scenario

Use the Dallas County Living-Cost Planning Guide. Start with **\$3,450 monthly after-tax income** for one adult with no children.

Source labels: Dallas County · one adult/no children · updated February 15, 2026 · living-cost estimate

CATEGORY	REFERENCE AMOUNT	MY FIRST BUDGET
Food	\$335	\$
Medical	\$253	\$
Housing	\$1,484	\$
Transportation	\$703	\$
Civic	\$215	\$
Internet and mobile	\$121	\$
Other	\$339	\$
Savings or emergency goal	not separate in the source total	\$
Total expenses	\$3,450 before added savings	\$
Money left: \$3,450 - total expenses		\$

My total is **below / equal to / above** the available income.

Part 2: Make one lifestyle choice

Choose one realistic change. You may reduce a category, share housing, use a different transportation plan, add income, or delay a want. Do not erase the first budget.

My change and amount: _____

Why this change fits the lifestyle I want: _____

Part 3: Build the revised budget

CATEGORY	REVISED AMOUNT	WHY IT CHANGED OR STAYED
Food	\$	
Medical	\$	
Housing	\$	
Transportation	\$	
Civic	\$	
Internet and mobile	\$	
Other	\$	
Savings or emergency goal	\$	
Total expenses	\$	
Money left: \$3,450 - total expenses	\$	

EXPLAIN THE PLAN

Which two categories take the most money, and what percentage of the \$3,450 income do they use together?

Calculation: (\$ _____ + \$ _____) ÷ \$3,450 × 100 = _____ %

Reason these are my two largest categories: _____

What would change if this household included a child, debt payment, or different health need?

How could an entrepreneur use this budget without confusing revenue with personal income?

Part 4: Explain and stress-test the decision

1. Which lifestyle choice changed the revised budget most? Explain why.

2. Name one expense that is difficult to change quickly and one expense that may be more flexible.

3. Explain why business revenue is not the same as the money an owner can use for personal expenses.

4. Name one question you would verify before using this plan for a real household.

Done when

- ☐ My first and revised budget each show a total.
- ☐ My revised budget does not spend more than the available income.
- ☐ I used the household, place, date, and measure labels correctly.
- ☐ I explained the difference between business revenue and personal income.
- ☐ I explained one lifestyle decision and one budget tradeoff.
- ☐ I named one fact I would verify before using the plan in real life.